

Think College and Pacer's National Parent Center on Transition and Employment are happy to present today's webinar...

You Don't Say! Family Involvement, Expectations, Communication, and FERPA Requirements

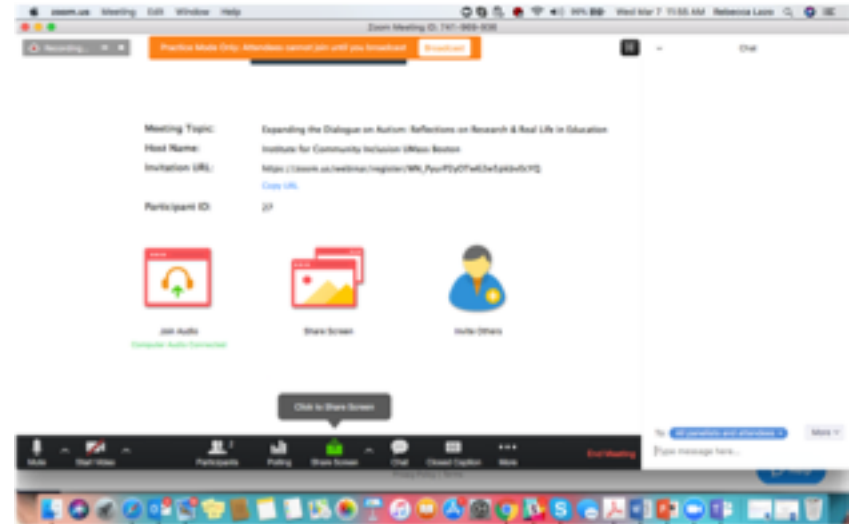
Barb Ziemke, Co-Director

National Parent Center on Transition and Employment



Helpful Tips for Using Zoom

- As participants, you are automatically muted. You are not on camera.
- The black bar at the bottom (or sometimes top) of your screen is your control panel.
- If it is not already showing, you can click on Chat to make the chat pod show up.
- Select “All panelists & attendees” as the option under “To” so your questions & comments show up for all to see.



Live captioning of today's event is available here:

<https://www.streamtext.net/player?event=ICI>



The TPSID National Coordinating Center at Think College is a project of the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston.
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You Don't Say!
Family Involvement,
Expectations, Communication,
and FERPA Requirements
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- ✓ Minnesota's Parent Training and Information Center
- ✓ Home to PACER's **National Parent Center on Transition and Employment**
- ✓ Partner in **Think College Coordinating Center**



PACER's National Parent Center on Transition and Employment

Promotes:

- Family involvement in transition
- Building professional capacity to effectively engage and support families
- High expectations

Provides:

- Information, resources and referral
- Direct assistance to families
- National conferences and technical assistance

www.pacer.org/transition

PACER's National Parent Center on Transition and Employment™

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Learning Center

Find helpful information and resources on transition topics such as independent living, postsecondary education, and employment.

[Learn more](#)

Features

Vote!

I care about my community.

Vote! It's Your Right and Responsibility

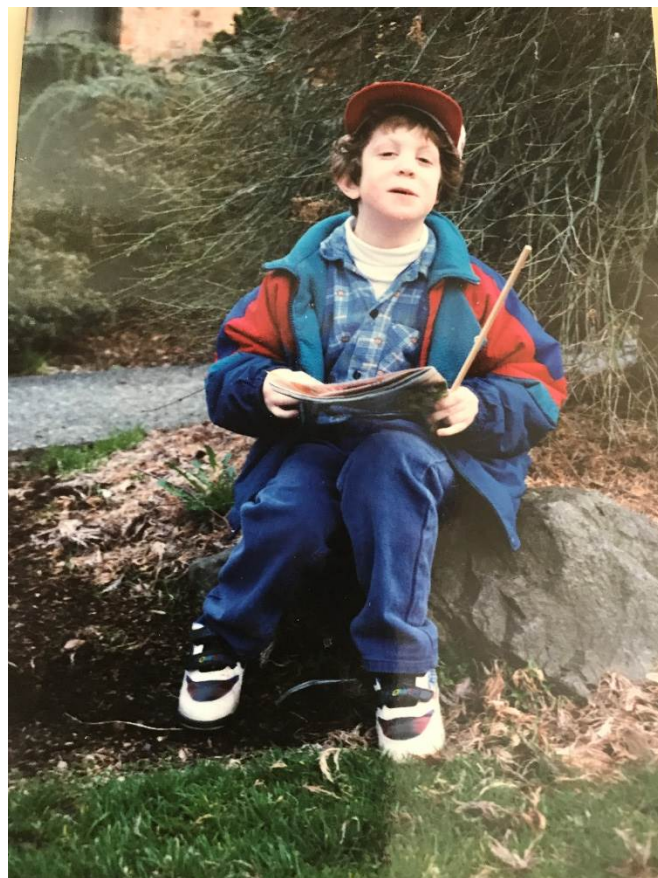
A message from the Oregon Council on Developmental Disabilities, Disability Rights Oregon and the Oregon Secretary of State.

[10 Tips for Voters With Disabilities](#)

www.facebook.com/npcte



The Power of Parents' High Expectations and the Parent-Professional Partnership



Student Services Standard 4: Have a stated process for family engagement and communication that reflects:

- Clearly defined roles and responsibilities...
- A process for the provision of information to parents...
- Student control over parental involvement
- Adheres to the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)



The Changing Landscape of College Parent Involvement



COLLEGE PARENT CENTRAL





Parent Involvement: What's Expected?

- Student
- Parent(s)
- College program staff
 - Peer-mentors
- The college at large
 - Faculty
 - RA's



What is different for CTP families?

- Ability, skill level and developmental stage of the student
- Adult-living destination and pathway options
- Complexity of service systems requiring family facilitation



Positive Parent Involvement Can Support Self-Determination

- Effective parent involvement practices support families in the ongoing development of the young adult's self-determination and independence.
- Encourage parents to “Let grow” rather than “Let go.”



Take a Person-Centered View of “Independence”

Beware of the rugged individualism stereotype. None of us really live independently. Family interdependence is the norm.

~ Frederic Schroeder, NFB,
Former RSA Commissioner



Supporting High Expectations



What “high expectations” do you hold for your student and families?



What supports may they need to meet those expectations?

Without support, high expectations are but a hollow promise.

- ~ Vincent Tinto, Syracuse University

FAPQ: What do parents want to know?



Is the student well-supervised?

What is the process if something goes wrong?

Who helps with school work?

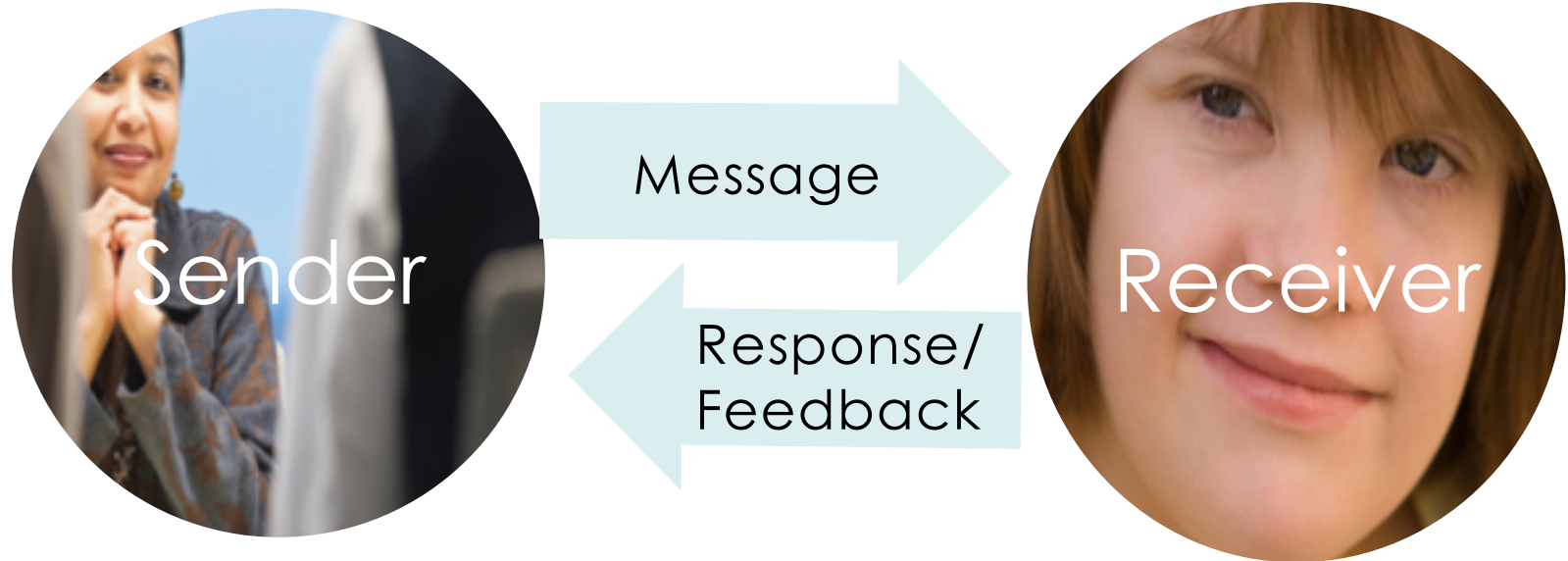
Is “no news, good news?”

Is he making friends?

Is she anxious, depressed?

Are they on-track academically?

Complete the Communication Loop



The single biggest problem in communication is the illusion that it has taken place.

~ George Bernard Shaw

Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) Information & Resources

- [Family Policy Compliance Office](#)
- [Disclosure of Information from Education Records to Parents of Postsecondary Students](#) Guidance from the FPCO
- [Communicating with Your Student's College under Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act](#) PACER publication
- [Student Privacy 101: FERPA for Parents and Students](#) (4-minute video from FPCO)

FERPA: Opportunities

- Necessitates a shift in the parent and family perspective
- Presents an opportunity for a family conversation that may have been put off until now
- Provides an opportunity for student to engage in problem-solving, informed decision-making and personal choice



Legal Guardianship & Supported Decision-Making

- The term “parent” is defined in FERPA as “including natural parents, a guardian, or an individual acting as a parent in the absence of a parent or a guardian.”
- Rutgers Policy on Parental Notification: “...When a student chooses to enlist the support of parent(s) or legal guardian(s), the staff at Rutgers is happy to work in partnership with the student and parent(s) or legal guardian(s)...”

Potential FERPA Family Concern

- The release of directory information may be an issue for vulnerable students who may not fully understand what may be released without their consent or the process to refuse release.
 - <http://erm.rutgers.edu/departments/FERPA/documents/Annual%20FERPA%20Notice%20to%20Students.pdf>
 - <http://www.registrar.umd.edu/current/Policies/FERPA.html>

FERPA Annual Notification: What is required for students with disabilities?

34 CFR 99.7

(b) An educational agency or institution may provide this notice by any means that are reasonably likely to inform the parents or eligible students of their rights.

(1) An educational agency or institution shall effectively notify parents or eligible students who are disabled



College Parent Involvement Strategies for Student Success

1. Create parent partnerships by building relationships
2. Provide parent orientation programming
3. Proactively supply parents with handbooks and print materials that students receive with key information and important dates
4. Establish a clear chain of command and a list of campus resources with contact information
5. Provide up-front, clear and adequate information about FERPA

(Summarized from Cutright, M. (2008), New Directions for Higher Education)

And the Survey says...

PACER's Family Engagement Survey for Program Staff and Families

- *Developing and implementing a stated process for family involvement*
 - What's working, what's not, what's needed?
- Email invitation with Survey Monkey link
 - Drawing for a \$25.00 gift card
 - New resources to share
- Questions: bziemke@pacer.or



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